

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Family Paralegal role advertised through Reed. I am a law graduate with hands-on experience managing client matters, preparing legal documentation and supporting casework across a range of sensitive legal issues — and I am keen to build a long-term career within family law at your practice.

In my current role as a Legal Adviser at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I work daily with clients on family, housing, employment, welfare and debt matters, many of whom are in vulnerable circumstances. I take detailed factual statements, establish chronologies, identify relevant legal and evidential issues, and translate complex procedural rules into clear, practical guidance. A significant portion of my caseload involves family-adjacent matters, including clients dealing with domestic abuse, relationship breakdown and child welfare concerns. I manage matters from instruction through to submission, drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and maintaining confidential case records — all to deadline.

Prior to this, I spent a year on placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, supporting both international arbitration and real estate disputes. That experience gave me strong foundations in evidence review, electronic bundling, hearing preparation, deadline tracking and client liaison. I also supported skeleton arguments and court materials, and coordinated document management across competing matters under time pressure. A partner and associate noted that my performance was comparable to that of a newly qualified solicitor.

I understand that high-quality client care in family law means being organised and accurate, but also being measured and human in how you communicate with people at difficult points in their lives. That balance — procedural rigour alongside genuine client focus — is something I have developed across both advisory and litigation-support settings.

I am based in Maidenhead, which places me well for the Marlborough location, and I am committed to developing my practice within family law on a long-term basis. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Fernanda Silva